

The lowest electricity burden in the EU?

Testing a ministry claim about household electricity prices against Eurostat and the IMF

THE CLAIM UNDER REVIEW

“...the burden on Maltese families is the lowest in the EU, at 14.33 PPS per 100kWh.”

Ministry for the Environment, Energy and Public Cleanliness, 6 May 2025.
Based on Eurostat figures for the second half of 2024.

VERDICT: LARGELY SUPPORTED

Accurate figures; the subsidy cost is left out

TL;DR

On 6 May 2025 the Energy Ministry said that “**Malta has the lowest electricity prices for domestic consumers in the European Union when measured in terms of purchasing power standards**”, and that “the burden on Maltese families is the lowest in the EU, at 14.33 PPS per 100kWh”. We checked every figure against Eurostat and looked at what keeps the price low.

- 1

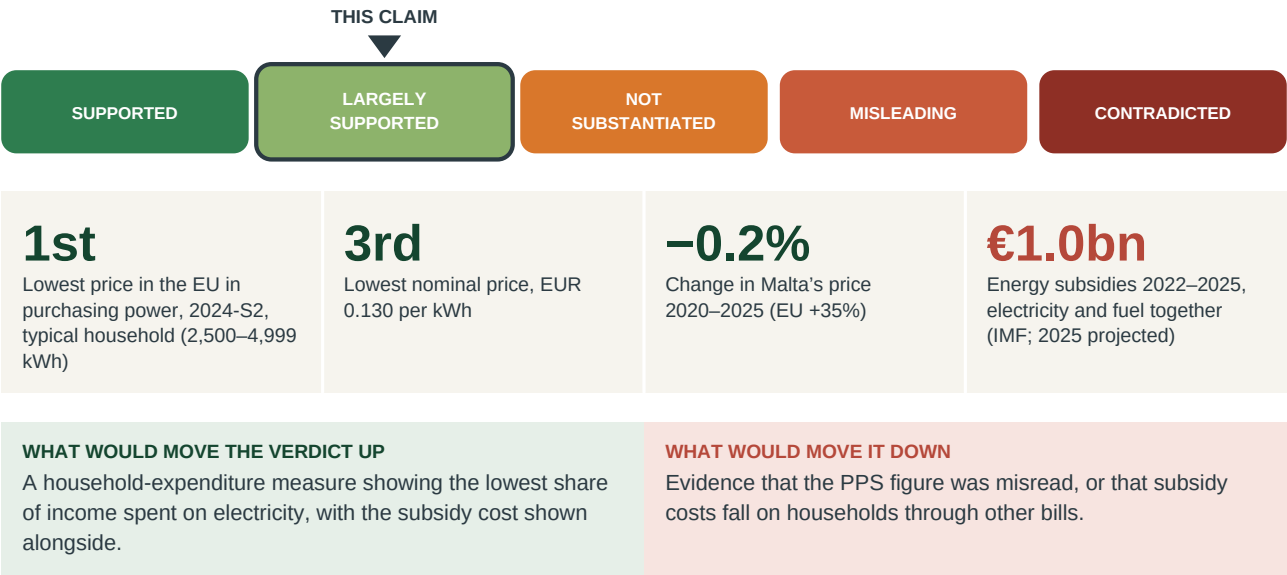
Every figure checks out. For a typical household (2,500–4,999 kWh a year, Eurostat’s standard band), Eurostat now shows Malta at 14.35 PPS per 100 kWh in the second half of 2024, the lowest of 27 countries; the nominal price of EUR 0.130 is the third lowest; the Czech, Cypriot and German figures match exactly. In other consumption bands Malta is not the cheapest.
- 2

Prices really were stable. Malta’s household price was flat between 2020 and 2025 (–0.2%) while the EU average rose 35%.
- 3

The price is held down with public money. Eurostat’s series shows Malta’s household price cut from EUR 0.169 to 0.125 per kWh in 2014 and kept between EUR 0.125 and 0.133 since. The IMF puts energy subsidies, which cover fuel as well as electricity, at 1.8% of GDP in 2022, falling to about 0.8% in 2025 (a projection); roughly EUR 1 billion over four years, paid through public finances; the electricity share is not published separately. The IMF recommends phasing out untargeted subsidies.
- 4

Few households struggle with bills. 7.6% of people cannot keep their home adequately warm (EU 8.8%) and 4.5% are in arrears on utility bills (EU 7.0%).
- 5

Verdict: largely supported (high confidence). The comparison is accurate. “Burden” is measured by price only; the cost of keeping that price low falls on the state budget, which the release does not mention.



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1 The claim

The press release by the Ministry for the Environment, Energy and Public Cleanliness was read in full [1].

What was said	Access
“Malta has the lowest electricity prices for domestic consumers in the European Union when measured in terms of purchasing power standards (PPS)... for the second half of 2024.”	Read in full
“...third-lowest nominal electricity price... at €0.131 per unit... the burden on Maltese families is the lowest in the EU, at 14.33 PPS per 100kWh.” Czech Republic 41.00, Cyprus 35.70, Germany 35.23 PPS.	Read in full
“This is clear confirmation that our policy is working for the benefit of the people.” (Minister Miriam Dalli)	Read in full

2 Method

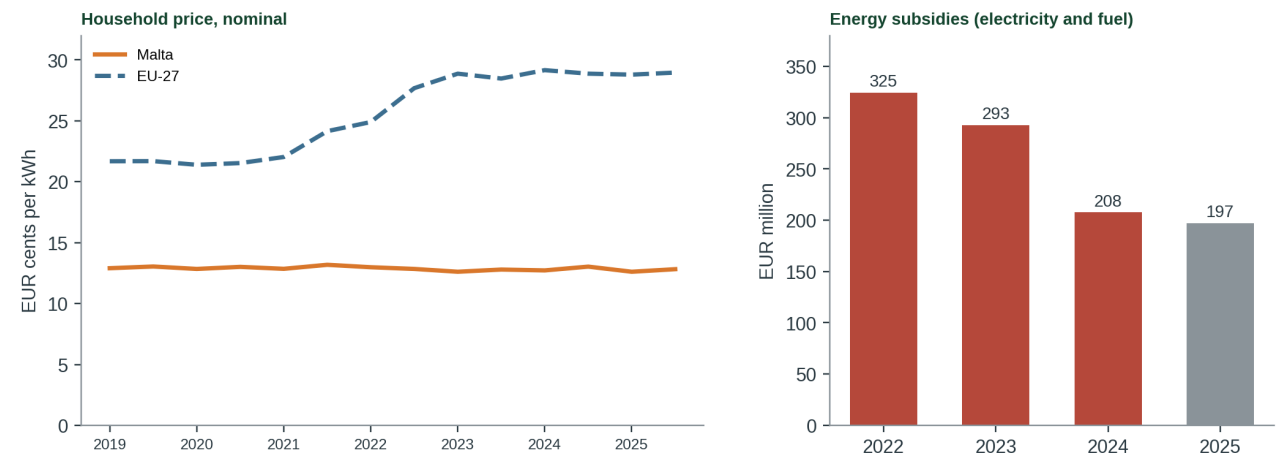
Eurostat household electricity prices (band DC, 2,500–4,999 kWh a year, all taxes) for all EU countries, 2019–2025, in euros and purchasing power standards, with the other consumption bands and Malta’s price since 2012 for comparison [2]; Eurostat energy-poverty indicators [3]; energy subsidies from the IMF’s 2025 Article IV report [4], converted to euros with Eurostat GDP. Numbers are recomputed by *tools/cc-022-report/calc.py*. Official statistics and assessments are grade C.

3 What the data show



Figure 1. Household electricity prices in the EU, second half of 2024, typical household (2,500–4,999 kWh). Malta is third cheapest in euros and cheapest once prices are adjusted for purchasing power.

Malta is cheapest only in this standard band, which the release uses; in the other bands in 2024-S2 it ranked 3rd (1,000–2,499 kWh), 2nd (5,000–14,999 kWh), 16th (under 1,000 kWh) and 23rd of 27 (15,000 kWh or more), and 4th of 26 on Eurostat’s all-band average [2].



Left: Eurostat nrg_pc_204. Right: IMF Country Report 26/29, Table 2 (% of GDP; 2025 grey = projection) x Eurostat nominal GDP.

Figure 2. Left: Malta’s price stayed flat while the EU average rose. Right: energy subsidies as the IMF reports them, covering fuel as well as electricity (2025 is a projection); the electricity share is not published separately.

Indicator	Claim	Eurostat / IMF	Grade
Malta, PPS per 100 kWh, 2024-S2, band 2,500–4,999 kWh	14.33, lowest	14.35, lowest of 27	C
Malta, nominal price, 2024-S2	EUR 0.131, third lowest	EUR 0.1303, third lowest	C
Czechia / Cyprus / Germany, PPS	41.00 / 35.70 / 35.23	41.00 / 35.70 / 35.23	C
Price change 2020-S1 → 2025-S2	“remained stable”	Malta –0.2%; EU +35.4%	C
Energy subsidies (electricity and fuel), 2022–2025	not mentioned	EUR 325m, 293m, 208m, 197m (2025 projected)	C
Unable to keep home warm, 2025	–	7.6% (EU 8.8%)	C
Arrears on utility bills, 2025	–	4.5% (EU 7.0%)	C

All values in data/cc-022/checks.csv.

4 Where the evidence points different ways

Q1 Is the burden on families the lowest in the EU?

ON PRICE, YES

EVIDENCE FOR THE CLAIM'S IMPRESSION

For a typical household (2,500–4,999 kWh), price adjusted for purchasing power is the lowest in the EU, and fewer Maltese than average struggle to pay bills or heat their homes.

EVIDENCE AGAINST

PPS adjusts for general price levels, not for how much electricity households use or their income; it is a price comparison, not a measure of burden.

WHY THEY DIFFER, AND WHAT IT MEANS HERE

For this claim: as a statement about price for a typical household, it is accurate.

Q2 Is it confirmation that the policy works?

INCOMPLETE

EVIDENCE FOR THE CLAIM'S IMPRESSION

Prices stayed flat through the 2022 energy shock, protecting households.

EVIDENCE AGAINST

The stability is paid for through public finances: the IMF puts energy subsidies, for electricity and fuel together, at about EUR 1 billion in 2022–2025, with 2025 projected [4]; the IMF recommends replacing untargeted subsidies with cost-recovery tariffs and targeted support.

WHY THEY DIFFER, AND WHAT IT MEANS HERE

For this claim: the release presents the benefit without its cost.

5 Testing the claim

Sub-claim	What the evidence shows	Rating
A. Lowest price in PPS, 2024-S2	Confirmed by Eurostat for the standard household band (2,500–4,999 kWh), the one the release uses; not the lowest in other bands [2].	SUPPORTED
B. Third-lowest nominal price; comparison figures	Confirmed [2].	SUPPORTED
C. Prices stable since 2020	–0.2% vs EU +35% [2].	SUPPORTED
D. Lowest “burden” on families	True for price; the subsidy cost is not counted [4].	LARGELY SUPPORTED

6 Verdict and requests for evidence

VERDICT

LARGELY SUPPORTED

Every figure is accurate; the cost of keeping prices low is left out. Confidence: high.

Why. The statistical claims match Eurostat exactly. The word “burden” and the minister’s conclusion rest on price alone, while fixed electricity and fuel prices are financed by public subsidies the IMF puts at about EUR 1 billion over 2022–2025 (electricity and fuel together; 2025 projected). That omission qualifies the claim without contradicting it.

Evidence we are asking for

- ☐ The electricity-only subsidy to Enemalta by year, separate from fuel.
- ☐ Household spending on electricity as a share of income, by income group.

7 Limitations

- The IMF subsidy series covers electricity and fuel; 2025 is a staff projection.
- The comparison uses band DC (2,500–4,999 kWh), a typical household; Malta is not the cheapest in the other bands (Section 3).
- The release gives 14.33 PPS; Eurostat’s current figure is 14.35. We did not keep the data as published in May 2025, so we cannot say whether this reflects a revision; the ranking is the same.

References

- [1] Ministry for the Environment, Energy and Public Cleanliness (6 May 2025). Electricity prices in the EU: Maltese households with lowest burden. PR250746en. <https://www.gov.mt/en/Government/DOI/Press%20Releases/Pages/2025/05/06/pr250746en.aspx>
- [2] Eurostat. nrg_pc_204, electricity prices for household consumers; retrieved 4 Oct 2026 (other consumption bands and Malta’s series since 2012 retrieved 5 Oct 2026). https://ec.europa.eu/eurostat/databrowser/view/nrg_pc_204/default/table
- [3] Eurostat. ilc_mdcs01, ilc_mdcs07; retrieved 4 Oct 2026. https://ec.europa.eu/eurostat/databrowser/view/ilc_mdcs01/default/table
- [4] International Monetary Fund (2026). Malta: 2025 Article IV Consultation. Country Report 26/29, Table 2 and para. on energy subsidies. doi:10.5089/9798229038249.002. <https://www.imf.org/-/media/files/publications/cr/2026/english/1mltea2026001-source-pdf.pdf>
- [5] MiŻien. Data and calculations: data/cc-022/; tools/cc-022-report/.

Appendix A: series standards and verdict scale

Every investigation in this series follows the same rules so that verdicts are comparable and challengeable.

Verdict	Meaning
SUPPORTED	Evidence consistently backs the claim as stated.
LARGELY SUPPORTED	Backed by the evidence, with minor caveats that do not change the substance.
NOT SUBSTANTIATED	Stated more strongly than the evidence offered or available allows. May be true in some conditions but has not been shown.
MISLEADING	Omits material facts so that the overall impression is inaccurate, even if individual statements are defensible.
CONTRADICTED	The available evidence points against the claim.

Confidence

High: multiple independent lines of evidence agree. **Moderate:** evidence is relevant but incomplete or indirect. **Low:** evidence is thin, second-hand or conflicting.

Evidence grades

A experiment · B observational study with a control or gradient · C review, guidance or official statistics · D assertion or anecdote.

Standards

- **Quote the speaker, not the headline**, with outlet and date, and link the original where possible.
- **Separate the claim from the evidence offered for it**, and say who made which statement.
- **Grade the evidence** and show differing views side by side where the evidence is unsettled.
- **State what we could not access or verify**, and what would change the verdict either way.
- **Ask for the missing evidence** in specific, answerable requests.
- **Offer a right of reply** before wider circulation and append responses.
- **Correct errors openly** with a version number and change log.
- **Whistle-blow only on evidence:** a verdict of *Misleading* or *Contradicted* requires documents or data that can be shown, not inference.
- **Check every side.** Government, opposition, NGOs and developers are held to the same standard.

Appendix B: revision log

Version	Date	Change
1.0	4 Oct 2026	First issue. Right of reply to the Energy Ministry not yet sent.
1.1	5 Oct 2026	Corrections. (1) “Lowest in the EU” now says it holds for the standard household band (2,500–4,999 kWh) (TL;DR, tile, Figure 1 caption, table, Q1, sub-claim A, flyer, thumbnail); added one sentence on the other bands (2024-S2: 3rd, 2nd, 16th, 23rd of 27; 4th of 26 on the all-band average). (2) “Tariffs have been frozen since 2014” (no source) → Eurostat’s series: EUR 0.169 (2013-S2) to 0.125 per kWh (2014-S2), then 0.125–0.133 to 2025-S2. (3) The IMF’s EUR 1 billion is now described as energy subsidies for electricity and fuel together, with 2025 projected: Figure 2 caption “what that stability cost” → “energy subsidies as the IMF reports them”; “tariff freeze is financed by” → “fixed electricity and fuel prices are financed by” (TL;DR, Q2, Why, table, tile, flyer). (4) “Eurostat revised 14.33 to 14.35” → difference noted without asserting a revision. (5) IMF reference: DOI added. Verdict and confidence unchanged.